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Life After Work— What You Can Do

We've seen that the job can be a lousy place to search for meaning in life. So what's the alternative? Where *can* we find meaning?

WORK ISN'T ALL BAD

Before retiring I struggled with this question more than with any other aspect of my new life.

Work isn't all bad—it beats being bored. When you leave the nine-to-five you've got to come up with something better. Whatever it is, it has to do more than the job did in helping you find meaning in life—even if the job didn't do very much.

"What time do you plan to get up in the morning?" envious friends would ask before I retired.

"Anytime I want," I answered. But behind my cocky response lay uncertainty. Just what the hell would I get up *for*? Jane Pauley has pretty hair, and Bryant Gumble a soothing voice, but would I drag my ass out of bed and watch *Today* at seven if I had nothing to do at nine? Morning meetings are dull, but nothing compared to *As the World Turns*.